

The Garden Party

Katherine Mansfield · 1922

First published: Westminster Gazette, Feb 1922

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

One 90-minute lesson (the whole story), with an optional take-home essay

Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–1), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Reading text: https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/The_Garden_Party,_and_Other_Stories/The_Garden-Party (revision 14693900), cleaned for Liber et Libri.

Grades: Grades 10–12 (scales to graduate via rigor levels). Short story: read whole in one 90-minute lesson (assign longer stories as pre-reading). The scaffolded-support track works from the full text with scaffolds. **Weeks:** 1. **Class days:** 2 × 90 minutes (1 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does The Garden Party suggest about class and privilege?
- What does The Garden Party suggest about life and death?
- What does The Garden Party suggest about coming of age?

Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the story in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.
- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the story quizzes.
- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

Standards: Common Core

RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily story quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-story test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Scaffolded support through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Story lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* The Garden Party	2 × 90 min (180 min)	*class and privilege* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Story quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to The Garden Party

Objective: Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about Katherine Mansfield's life or times connects to class and privilege in “The Garden Party”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (class and privilege, life and death, coming of age).

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2

Author biography

Katherine Mansfield was born Kathleen Mansfield Beauchamp in Wellington, New Zealand, on 14 October 1888, into a wealthy family. She moved to London at nineteen, lived among modernist writers including Virginia Woolf and D. H. Lawrence, and married the critic John Middleton Murry. Her collections Bliss (1920) and The Garden Party (1922) helped create the modern plotless, impressionistic short story. She died of tuberculosis near Fontainebleau, France, on 9 January 1923, aged 34.

Historical and cultural context

Set in a wealthy suburb of Wellington, New Zealand, modelled on Mansfield's childhood home on Tinakori Road. Colonial New Zealand society kept sharp class divisions; the workmen's cottages lay just below the big houses.

Publication and reception, then and now

First published in the Westminster Gazette (Saturday edition) in February 1922; collected in The Garden Party and Other Stories (1922).

Then: The collection was a critical success in the last year of Mansfield's life.

Now: A classic of modernist short fiction, taught for its shifting point of view, class critique and unresolved epiphany.

Overview (spoiler-free)

The Sheridan family prepares for a lavish garden party. Laura, the youngest daughter, learns that a working man who lived in the cottages nearby has been killed in an accident, and wants to cancel the party.

Main themes

- class and privilege.
- life and death.
- coming of age.

Why it matters

The story asks what we owe neighbours whose lives we don't see.

Spoilers · teacher only

Her mother refuses; after the party Laura takes leftover food to the widow, sees the dead man, and is moved by his peaceful beauty; she can only stammer to her brother, "Isn't life—".

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Before we open The Garden Party: Have you ever felt awkward about having something others didn't?
Prompt: Before we open The Garden Party: Have you ever felt awkward about having something others didn't?

8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)
Key literary terms for the unit.
free indirect discourse; epiphany; modernism; symbol.

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).
About the author. Katherine Mansfield was born Kathleen Mansfield Beauchamp in Wellington, New Zealand, on 14 October 1888, into a wealthy family. She moved to London at nineteen, lived among modernist writers including Virginia Woolf and D. H. Lawrence, and married the critic John Middleton Murry. Her collections Bliss (1920) and The Garden Party (1922) helped create the modern plotless, impressionistic short story. She died of tuberculosis near Fontainebleau, France, on 9 January 1923, aged 34. The world of the book. Set in a wealthy suburb of Wellington, New Zealand, modelled on Mansfield's childhood home on Tinakori Road. Colonial New Zealand society kept sharp class divisions; the workmen's cottages lay just below the big houses. Publication and reception. First published in the Westminster Gazette (Saturday edition) in February 1922; collected in The Garden Party and Other Stories (1922). Then: The collection was a critical success in the last year of Mansfield's life. Now: A classic of modernist short fiction, taught for its shifting point of view, class critique and unresolved epiphany.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)
Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Isn't life," she stammered, "isn't life" slowly and put it in my own words: After seeing the dead man, Laura tries to say what life is and cannot finish her sentence. Next, craft. I notice the repetition and the break, which show she has no words for what she has felt. The strongest word is "stammered": it shows emotion has outrun language. Then, effect. What does Laura's unfinished question tell us? My answer: Laura has learned something too big to put into words; Mansfield ends on a feeling, not a lesson, and leaves the meaning open.

> *Isn't life," she stammered, "isn't life (The Garden Party, paragraph 187)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Isn't life," she stammered, "isn't life" slowly and put it in my own words: After seeing the dead man, Laura tries to say what life is and cannot finish her sentence. Next, craft. I notice the repetition and the break, which show she has no words for what she has felt. The strongest word is "stammered": it shows emotion has outrun language. Then, effect. What does Laura's unfinished question tell us? My answer: Laura has learned something too big to put into words; Mansfield ends on a feeling, not a lesson, and leaves the meaning open.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)
Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.
What the book is about (no spoilers): The Sheridan family prepares for a lavish garden party. Laura, the youngest daughter, learns that a working man who lived in the cottages nearby has been killed in an accident, and wants to cancel the party. Themes to track: class and privilege.: life and death.: coming of age.:

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Page: class and privilege. Prediction: Laura's family party will be shadowed by a death among the poor cottages below the Sheridans' house. Question: should the party go on, and what will Laura learn by asking?
Task: Set up a reading journal for The Garden Party: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Page: class and privilege. Prediction: Laura's family party will be shadowed by a death among the poor cottages below the Sheridans' house. Question: should the party go on, and what will Laura learn by asking?

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.
Why does The Garden Party still matter? The story asks what we owe neighbours whose lives we don't see.
Anchor question: Why might The Garden Party still be taught today?
Facilitation: The story asks what we owe neighbours whose lives we don't see.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)
Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).
Mansfield grew up in a wealthy family in Wellington, New Zealand, and later moved to London. How might her own upbringing shape a story about a rich family's party? Answer: Accept answers such as: she knew the habits and class attitudes of wealthy families from the inside; the setting is based on her childhood home; she could both love and criticize that world.
Exit ticket: Mansfield grew up in a wealthy family in Wellington, New Zealand, and later moved to London. How might her own upbringing shape a story about a rich family's party?
Answer: Accept answers such as: she knew the habits and class attitudes of wealthy families from the inside; the setting is based on her childhood home; she could both love and criticize that world.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Preview the first reading.
Tomorrow we begin reading: The Garden Party.

Teacher notes · sources: Katherine Mansfield House and Garden, Wellington (https://www.katherinemansfield.com/); Britannica, "Katherine Mansfield" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/Katherine-Mansfield); Katherine Mansfield Society (https://www.katherinemansfieldsociety.org/)

Flags (verify before teaching):

- Verify exact date of the Westminster Gazette publication (February 1922 is commonly cited).

Lesson 2: The Garden Party

Focus: a girl's first encounter with death across the class line

Objective: Students will analyze how point of view develops in “The Garden Party” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (death of a working man, viewing a body, alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): Sensitive content: Death of a working man; viewing a body. Preview the story, tell students in advance, and allow a pass on reading aloud. Keep discussion on how the writer uses these elements, not on graphic detail. This section mentions drinking or a drug (“…had washed her hair before breakfast, and she sat drinking her coffee in a green turban, with a da…”). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: Heads-up: this story includes death of a working man; viewing a body.
Suggested language: “Why does the writer include this, and what does it make us notice?”

Teacher only · spoilers

The wealthy Sheridans prepare a garden party. Laura learns that a young carter from the poor cottages below, Scott, has been killed, and wants to cancel; her mother and sister refuse. After the party, Laura takes a basket of leftovers to the widow and is led to see the dead man, who looks peaceful and beautiful. She apologizes for her hat and, sobbing, tries to tell her brother Laurie what life is.

Background: Published in 1922 in the Westminster Gazette; Mansfield drew on her childhood in Wellington, New Zealand.

Significance: A modernist story of free indirect discourse and epiphany.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Should a happy event go on when something sad happens nearby? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to class and privilege because.... Content note before we start: Heads-up: this story includes death of a working man; viewing a body.
Prompt: Should a happy event go on when something sad happens nearby?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to class and privilege because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Four key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: meaningly — in a way meant to suggest something unspoken; supervise — to watch over and direct work; ripened — grew ripe; enigmatically — in a mysterious, puzzling way. "meaningly": Origin: an English formation from meaning + -ly.
Words: meaningly: in a way meant to suggest something unspoken · supervise: to watch over and direct work · ripened: grew ripe · enigmatically: in a mysterious, puzzling way

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Published in 1922 in the Westminster Gazette; Mansfield drew on her childhood in Wellington, New Zealand. A modernist story of free indirect discourse and epiphany. Point of view: Free indirect discourse slips into Laura's (and others') voices. Symbolism: Laura's hat, a gift of luxury, marks her class even at the cottage. Irony: The family calls her "absurd" for wanting to cancel. Watch for the hat: class privilege.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "You are being very absurd, Laura" slowly and put it in my own words: Laura wants to cancel the party because a workman nearby has died, and her sister tells her she is being absurd. Next, craft. I notice the word is said calmly, as if the matter is obvious. The strongest word is "absurd": it dismisses her empathy as silly, which is how the wealthy family protects its comfort. Then, effect. Why does Laura's family call her "absurd"? My answer: The family thinks feeling for a poor neighbor is unreasonable; the line shows the class blindness Laura is just starting to see.

> *You are being very absurd, Laura* *(The Garden Party, paragraph 123)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "You are being very absurd, Laura" slowly and put it in my own words: Laura wants to cancel the party because a workman nearby has died, and her sister tells her she is being absurd. Next, craft. I notice the word is said calmly, as if the matter is obvious. The strongest word is "absurd": it dismisses her empathy as silly, which is how the wealthy family protects its comfort. Then, effect. Why does Laura's family call her "absurd"? My answer: The family thinks feeling for a poor neighbor is unreasonable; the line shows the class blindness Laura is just starting to see.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Laura's apology to the dead man. Look at the craft: Laura's hat, a gift of luxury, marks her class even at the cottage. Ask: How does this line connect to class and privilege? Expected: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don't expect sacrifices from us." (Laura's apology to the dead man.)

> *Forgive my hat (The Garden Party, paragraph 178)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Laura's apology to the dead man. Look at the craft: Laura's hat, a gift of luxury, marks her class even at the cottage.
Ask: How does this line connect to class and privilege?
Expected answer: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don't expect sacrifices from us." (Laura's apology to the dead man.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the story for point of view, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about a girl's first encounter with death across the class line? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Garden Party develops the idea of a girl's first encounter with death across the class line. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. When the text says "You are being very absurd, Laura" (The Garden Party, paragraph 123), it shows this directly. Her mother says "You are being very absurd, Laura," yet at the cottage Laura says "Forgive my hat," aware of her privilege; she finds the dead man "wonderful, beautiful" and cannot express what she has learned.
Task: Annotate the story for point of view, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about a girl's first encounter with death across the class line? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Garden Party develops the idea of a girl's first encounter with death across the class line. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. When the text says "You are being very absurd, Laura" (The Garden Party, paragraph 123), it shows this directly. Her mother says "You are being very absurd, Laura," yet at the cottage Laura says "Forgive my hat," aware of her privilege; she finds the dead man "wonderful, beautiful" and cannot express what she has learned.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Should a happy event go on when something sad happens nearby? Ask: has Laura changed?
Anchor question: Should a happy event go on when something sad happens nearby?
Facilitation: Ask: has Laura changed?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Story quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Story quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about a girl's first encounter with death across the class line? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. ("You are being very absurd, Laura", The Garden Party, paragraph 123). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about a girl's first encounter with death across the class line? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. ("You are being very absurd, Laura", The Garden Party, paragraph 123). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how point of view shapes a girl's first encounter with death across the class line. Key takeaway: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don't expect sacrifices from us."

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Point of view:** Free indirect discourse slips into Laura's (and others') voices.
- **Symbolism:** Laura's hat, a gift of luxury, marks her class even at the cottage.
- **Irony:** The family calls her "absurd" for wanting to cancel.

Themes and how they develop

- **class and privilege:** Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don't expect sacrifices from us."

Symbols and motifs

- **the hat:** class privilege.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "You are being very absurd, Laura" (The Garden Party, paragraph 123) Her mother.
- "Forgive my hat" (The Garden Party, paragraph 178) Laura's apology to the dead man.
- "He was wonderful, beautiful" (The Garden Party, paragraph 176) Her vision of death.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view.
Evidence: "You are being very absurd, Laura" (The Garden Party, paragraph 123)

Reasoning: Her mother says "You are being very absurd, Laura," yet at the cottage Laura says "Forgive my hat," aware of her privilege; she finds the dead man "wonderful, beautiful" and cannot express what she has learned.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
meaningly (adverb)	in a way meant to suggest something unspoken	*She said meaningly, "I'm'er sister, miss.*	"meaningly": Origin: an English formation from meaning + -ly. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/meaningly#Etymology)
supervise (verb)	to watch over and direct work	*But Meg could not possibly go and supervise the men.*	
ripened (verb)	grew ripe	*And the perfect afternoon slowly ripened, slowly faded, slowly its petals closed.*	
enigmatically (adverb)	in a mysterious, puzzling way	*She looked mournfully and enigmatically at her mother and Laura as they came in.*	

Discussion questions

1. Should a happy event go on when something sad happens nearby?
2. Where does point of view appear in this story, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this story connect to the book's larger concern with class and privilege?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What are the Sheridans preparing? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A garden party
2. Who has died? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A young carter, Mr. Scott
3. What does Laura want to do when she hears the news? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Stop the party
4. What does Mrs. Sheridan give Laura to take? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A basket of leftover food

5. What does Laura say to the dead man? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Forgive my hat
6. Retell the three most important events of "The Garden Party" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The wealthy Sheridans prepare a garden party. Laura learns that a young carter from the poor cottages below, Scott, has been killed, and wants to cancel; her mother and sister refuse. After the party, Laura takes a basket of leftovers to the widow and is led to see the dead man, who looks peaceful and beautiful. She apologizes for her hat and, sobbing, tries to tell her brother Laurie what life…
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "The Garden Party"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the story; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "The Garden Party" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the story.
9. Reread: "She said meaningly, "I'm'er sister, miss." What does "meaningly" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: meaningly: in a way meant to suggest something unspoken.
10. Reread: "But Meg could not possibly go and supervise the men." What does "supervise" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: supervise: to watch over and direct work.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "The Garden Party" suggest about a girl's first encounter with death across the class line? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A modernist story of free indirect discourse and epiphany.
2. Find one example of point of view in this story. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know.
3. How does the imagery in this story shape what we understand about a girl's first encounter with death across the class line? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: "You are being very absurd, Laura" (The Garden Party, paragraph 123): Her mother. Theme link: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don't expect sacrifices from us." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins "But Meg could not possibly go and supervise the men.", why might Mansfield have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in "The Garden Party", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: The wealthy Sheridans prepare a garden party. Laura learns that a young carter from the poor cottages below, Scott, has been killed, and wants to cancel; her mother and sister refuse. After the party, Laura takes a basket of leftovers to the widow and is led to see the dead man, who looks peaceful…

6. As the opening story, what does “The Garden Party” set up that the rest of The Garden Party will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous story.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “Forgive my hat” (The Garden Party, paragraph 178): Laura's apology to the dead man. Theme link: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “He was wonderful, beautiful” (The Garden Party, paragraph 176): Her vision of death. Theme link: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Should a happy event go on when something sad happens nearby?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this story to the larger concern with class and privilege? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “You are being very absurd, Laura” (The Garden Party, paragraph 123): Her mother. On irony: The family calls her "absurd" for wanting to cancel. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Published in 1922 in the Westminster Gazette; Mansfield drew on her childhood in Wellington, New Zealand. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the story? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “Forgive my hat” (The Garden Party, paragraph 178): Laura's apology to the dead man. Theme link: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “A modernist story of free indirect discourse and epiphany.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the story. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “He was wonderful, beautiful” (The Garden Party, paragraph 176): Her vision of death. Theme link: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us."

Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. Which character in this story acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “You are being very absurd, Laura” (The Garden Party, paragraph 123): Her mother. Theme link: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “The Garden Party” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about a girl's first encounter with death across the class line? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “Forgive my hat” (The Garden Party, paragraph 178): Laura's apology to the dead man. On point of view: Free indirect discourse slips into Laura's (and others') voices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “The Garden Party”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “He was wonderful, beautiful” (The Garden Party, paragraph 176): Her vision of death. Theme link: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this story to life and death: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Mansfield need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “You are being very absurd, Laura” (The Garden Party, paragraph 123): Her mother. Theme link: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the point of view in this story effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “Forgive my hat” (The Garden Party, paragraph 178): Laura's apology to the dead man. On point of view: Free indirect discourse slips into Laura's (and others') voices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “The Garden Party” treats a girl's first encounter with death across the class line with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Garden Party see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “He was wonderful, beautiful” (The Garden Party, paragraph 176): Her vision of death. Theme link: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. As the final story, does this ending resolve class and privilege? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “You are being very absurd, Laura” (The Garden Party, paragraph 123): Her mother. Theme link: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this story (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a girl's first encounter with death across the class line? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “Forgive my hat” (The Garden Party, paragraph 178): Laura's apology to the dead man. Theme link: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Katherine Mansfield about this story, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Useful evidence: “He was wonderful, beautiful” (The Garden Party, paragraph 176): Her vision of death. Theme link: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Point of view:** look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Mrs. Sheridan give Laura to take?

   A. Money

   B. Her hat

C. A basket of leftover food

D. Flowers

Key: C (A basket of leftover food)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who has died?

A. A gardener

B. Laura's father

C. A neighbor's child

D. A young carter, Mr. Scott

Key: D (A young carter, Mr. Scott)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Laura want to do when she hears the news?

A. Hide

B. Visit the cottage at once

C. Tell Laurie

D. Stop the party

Key: D (Stop the party)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Laura say to the dead man?

A. Goodbye

B. I am sorry you died

C. Forgive my hat

D. Rest well

Key: C (Forgive my hat)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "She said _____, 'I'm'er sister, miss." Word bank: supervise, enigmatically, ripened, meaningly

Key: meaningly

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 35? "There, just inside the door, stood a wide, _____ tray full of pots of pink lilies."

A. shallow

B. archangels

C. attractive

D. perfect

Key: A (shallow)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What are the Sheridans preparing?

A. A wedding

B. A garden party

C. A funeral

D. A dance at a hotel

Key: B (A garden party)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 21: "Why couldn't she have _____ for friends rather than the silly boys she danced with and who came to Sunday night supper?"

Word bank: finished, workmen, suddenly, haggard

Key: workmen

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 1: “They could not have had a more _____ day for a garden-party if they had ordered it.” Word bank: suddenly, shallow, perfect, carried

   Key: perfect

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “But Meg could not possibly go and _____ the men.” Word bank: ripened, meaningly, enigmatically, supervise

    Key: supervise

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “He was wonderful, beautiful” (The Garden Party, paragraph 176) Answer in two or three sentences, quoting one word or phrase.

    Sample answer: Her vision of death. The evidence is “He was wonderful, beautiful” (The Garden Party, paragraph 176). This develops class and privilege: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.".

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 88 reveal about the character or situation? “I want to see how the men are getting on with the marquee.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 88) shows the situation turning on class and privilege: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.". The words “getting” and “marquee” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 1 reveal about the character or situation? “The gardener had been up since dawn, mowing the lawns and sweeping them, until the grass and the dark flat rosettes where the daisy plants had been seemed to shine.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 1) shows the situation turning on class and privilege: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.". The words “rosettes” and “gardener” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 24 shapes its tone: “In the hall her father and Laurie were brushing their hats ready to go to the office.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “brushing” and “father” (paragraph 24) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to class and privilege: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 14 shapes its tone: “You see, with a thing like a marquee,’ and he turned to Laura in his easy way, ‘you want to put it somewhere where it’ll give you a bang slap in the eye, if you follow me.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “somewhere” and “marquee” (paragraph 14) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to class and privilege: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 36 to the story's treatment of class and privilege: “She crouched down as if to warm herself at that blaze of lilies; she felt they were in her fingers, on her lips, growing in her breast.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 36) develops class and privilege: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect

sacrifices from us.". Its words “crouched” and “growing” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “In the drawing-room Meg, Jose and good little Hans had at last succeeded in moving the piano.” (paragraph 45), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating class and privilege as central.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from The Garden Party, paragraph 123: “You are being very _____, Laura”

    Key: absurd

18. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Forgive my hat” (The Garden Party, paragraph 178) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Laura's apology to the dead man. The evidence is “Forgive my hat” (The Garden Party, paragraph 178). This develops class and privilege: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.".

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 104 shapes its tone: “Little rags and shreds of smoke, so unlike the great silvery plumes that uncurled from the Sheridans’ chimneys.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “chimneys” and “uncurled” (paragraph 104) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to class and privilege: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “You are being very absurd, Laura” (The Garden Party, paragraph 123).

    Sample answer: Her mother says "You are being very absurd, Laura," yet at the cottage Laura says "Forgive my hat," aware of her privilege; she finds the dead man "wonderful, beautiful" and cannot express what she has learned. The evidence is “You are being very absurd, Laura” (The Garden Party, paragraph 123). This develops class and privilege: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.".

21. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 68 to the story's treatment of class and privilege: “Now, Laura,’ said her mother quickly, ‘come with me into the smoking-room.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 68) develops class and privilege: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.". Its words “smoking” and “quickly” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “The envelope was found at last behind the dining-room clock, though how it had got there Mrs. Sheridan could not…” (paragraph 69), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating class and privilege as central.

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 124 shapes its tone: “Just for a moment she had another glimpse of that poor woman and those little children, and the body being carried into the house.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “children” and “glimpse” (paragraph 124) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to class and privilege: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how class and privilege develops from the opening of “The Garden Party” to its ending. Use one quotation from each part.

    Sample answer: Near the start, “You are being very absurd, Laura” (The Garden Party, paragraph 123) — Her mother. Later, “He was wonderful, beautiful” (The Garden Party, paragraph 176), which shows her vision of death. Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.".

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 83? “All the same, they couldn’t help agreeing that the puffs looked very _____.”

    A. archangels

    B. shallow

    C. attractive

    D. children

    Key: C (attractive)

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 66: “And the _____ knew by her face that she hadn’t got them.” Word bank: perfect, attractive, shallow, children

    Key: children

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “He was wonderful, beautiful” (The Garden Party, paragraph 176). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Her vision of death. The evidence is “He was wonderful, beautiful” (The Garden Party, paragraph 176). This develops class and privilege: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.". The words “beautiful” and “wonderful” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Forgive my hat” (The Garden Party, paragraph 178) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Laura's apology to the dead man. The evidence is “Forgive my hat” (The Garden Party, paragraph 178). This develops class and privilege: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.". Her mother says "You are being very absurd, Laura," yet at the cottage Laura says "Forgive my hat," aware of her privilege; she finds the dead man "wonderful, beautiful" and cannot express what she has learned.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 145 to the story's treatment of class and privilege: “Lived just below in the lane, and leaves a wife and half a dozen kiddies, so they say.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 145) develops class and privilege: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.". Its words “kiddies” and “leaves” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “And, Laura!’—her mother followed her out of the marquee—‘don’t on any account———” (paragraph 155), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating class and privilege as central.

29. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “You are being very absurd, Laura” (The Garden Party, paragraph 123) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Her mother. The evidence is “You are being very absurd, Laura” (The Garden Party, paragraph 123). This develops class and privilege: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.".

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 160 to the story's treatment of class and privilege: “Beside the gate an old, old woman with a crutch sat in a chair, watching.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 160) develops class and privilege: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.". Its words “watching” and “crutch” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “To be away from those staring eyes, or to be covered up in anything, one of those women’s shawls even.” (paragraph 162), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating class and privilege as central.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “You are being very absurd, Laura” (The Garden Party, paragraph 123) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Her mother. The evidence is “You are being very absurd, Laura” (The Garden Party, paragraph 123). This develops class and privilege: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.". The words “absurd” and “being” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Her mother says "You are being very absurd, Laura," yet at the cottage Laura says "Forgive my hat," aware of her privilege; she finds the dead man "wonderful, beautiful" and cannot express what she has learned.

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Which literary element does this describe in “The Garden Party”? Laura's hat, a gift of luxury, marks her class even at the cottage.

    A. Symbolism

    B. Structure

    C. Personification

    D. Allusion

    Key: A (Symbolism)

33. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? “Forgive my hat” (The Garden Party, paragraph 178) Answer in two or three sentences, quoting one word or phrase.
    Sample answer: Laura's apology to the dead man. The evidence is “Forgive my hat” (The Garden Party, paragraph 178). This develops class and privilege: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.".

34. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “The Garden Party”? Free indirect discourse slips into Laura's (and others') voices.

    A. Simile

    B. Plot

    C. Point of view

    D. Allusion

    Key: C (Point of view)

35. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 13? “And she _____ to the lily-lawn with the hand that didn’t hold the bread-and-butter.”

    A. children

    B. finished

    C. workmen

    D. pointed

    Key: D (pointed)

36. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] In the line “She said meaningly, ‘I’m’er sister, miss.”, what does “meaningly” most nearly mean?

    A. in a mysterious, puzzling way

    B. to watch over and direct work

    C. in a way meant to suggest something unspoken

    D. grew ripe

    Key: C (in a way meant to suggest something unspoken)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1

HS Freshman	1, 10, 6, 8, 17, 7, 9, 4, 13, 18, 11, 12, 19, 20, 14, 21	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	17, 1, 6, 9, 4, 5, 2, 10, 3, 13, 12, 19, 20, 22, 16, 23	recall 9, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	9, 2, 24, 8, 3, 7, 4, 25, 13, 12, 19, 26, 20, 15, 27, 28	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	6, 1, 7, 5, 24, 8, 29, 13, 12, 26, 22, 14, 19, 23, 30, 28	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	7, 10, 1, 5, 2, 3, 26, 22, 15, 19, 14, 30, 21, 28, 31, 16	recall 6, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Freshman	7, 17, 8, 2, 3, 13, 18, 22, 32, 19, 15, 20, 30, 16, 28, 21	recall 5, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	17, 8, 7, 2, 3, 33, 14, 26, 15, 22, 34, 19, 28, 30, 21, 16	recall 5, inference 1, analysis 6, synthesis 4
College Junior	35, 36, 5, 10, 7, 32, 26, 22, 15, 19, 16, 28, 30, 31, 27, 21	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	3, 5, 7, 2, 1, 9, 19, 14, 22, 23, 30, 28, 31, 27, 21, 16	recall 6, inference 0, analysis 3, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	6, 5, 10, 7, 2, 1, 13, 11, 14, 20, 15, 21, 16, 23, 30, 28	recall 6, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “The Garden Party,” how does Mansfield show a girl's first encounter with death across the class line? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In The Garden Party, how does Mansfield develop the idea of a girl's first encounter with death across the class line? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the point of view in the story helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how The Garden Party develops the idea of a girl's first encounter with death across the class line. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of The Garden Party (where it begins, turns and ends) and its point of view shape the reader's understanding of a girl's first encounter with death across the class line. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what The Garden Party suggests about a girl's first encounter with death across the class line. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the story's point of view and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Katherine Mansfield uses point of view in The Garden Party to complicate the reader's understanding of a

girl's first encounter with death across the class line. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate The Garden Party within its historical and literary context and argue how the story's treatment of a girl's first encounter with death across the class line responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read The Garden Party alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the story's handling of a girl's first encounter with death across the class line follows or bends those conventions, using the point of view as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to The Garden Party and its treatment of a girl's first encounter with death across the class line. State your method, show what it reveals in the story's point of view and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads The Garden Party as evidence for a larger claim about a girl's first encounter with death across the class line in The Garden Party. Connect close reading of the story to the whole story, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads The Garden Party as a hinge in the story's larger treatment of a girl's first encounter with death across the class line. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Garden Party.

SAT-style questions

1. *She said meaningly, “I’m’er sister, miss.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “meaningly” most nearly mean?

   A. in a way meant to suggest something unspoken

   B. to watch over and direct work

   C. grew ripe

   D. in a mysterious, puzzling way

2. *But Meg could not possibly go and supervise the men. She had washed her hair before breakfast, and she sat drinking her coffee in a green turban, with a dark wet curl stamped on each cheek. Jose, the butterfly, always came down in a silk petticoat and a kimono jacket.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “The Garden Party”?

   A. Courage in defense of home

   B. Endurance turning to justice

   C. A girl's first encounter with death across the class line

D. Racial pride destroying love

SAT key: 1. A (in a way meant to suggest something unspoken); 2. C (A girl's first encounter with death across the class line)

Unit test

The Garden Party: end test · 90 minutes · 18 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 75: “They were _____ at last, and Laura took them off to the kitchen.” Word bank: archangels, shouldered, finished, carried

   Key: finished

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 17: “He had a _____ look as his dark eyes scanned the tennis-court.” Word bank: sandwich, haggard, shouldered, suddenly

   Key: haggard

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 48? “She _____ made them feel they were taking part in some drama.”

   A. haggard
   B. shallow
   C. archangels
   D. always

   Key: D (always)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 21? “Already the men had _____ their staves and were making for the place.”

   A. shallow
   B. carried
   C. haggard
   D. shouldered

   Key: D (shouldered)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 28? “It will only be a very scratch meal—just the _____ crusts and broken meringue-shells and what’s left over.”

   A. finished
   B. sandwich
   C. pointed
   D. shallow

   Key: B (sandwich)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 1? "Hundreds, yes, literally hundreds, had come out in a single night; the green bushes bowed down as though they had been visited by _____."

   A. sandwich

   B. archangels

   C. kitchen

   D. always

   Key: B (archangels)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 39: "And I _____ thought for once in my life I shall have enough canna lilies." Word bank: carried, suddenly, workmen, sandwich

   Key: suddenly

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 8: "They _____ staves covered with rolls of canvas, and they had big tool-bags slung on their backs." Word bank: finished, haggard, carried, workmen

   Key: carried

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 68? "Do you hear me, _____, or shall I have to tell your father when he comes home to-night?"

   A. children

   B. archangels

   C. sandwich

   D. always

   Key: A (children)

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 31: "The green baize door that led to the _____ regions swung open and shut with a muffled thud." Word bank: children, kitchen, shallow, shouldered

    Key: kitchen

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 21 reveal about the character or situation? "When Laura saw that gesture she forgot all about the karakas in her wonder at him caring for things like that—caring for the smell of lavender." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 21) shows the situation turning on coming of age: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don't expect sacrifices from us.". The words "lavender" and "gesture" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in the story?

    A. "The gardener had been up since dawn, mowing the lawns and sweeping them, until the grass and the dark flat rosettes where the daisy plants…"

    B. "Hundreds, yes, literally hundreds, had come out in a single night; the green bushes bowed down as though they had been visited by…"

    C. "They could not have had a more perfect day for a garden-party if they had ordered it."

    D. "It's so delicious to have an excuse for eating out of doors, and besides, she loved having to arrange things; she always felt she could do…"

Key: C (“They could not have had a more perfect day for a garden-party if they had ordered it.”)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 117 reveal about the character or situation? “If some one had died there normally—and I can’t understand how they keep alive in those poky little holes—we should still be having our party, shouldn’t we?” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 117) shows the situation turning on coming of age: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.". The words “understand” and “normally” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

14. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 45 reveal about the character or situation? “In the drawing-room Meg, Jose and good little Hans had at last succeeded in moving the piano.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 45) shows the situation turning on life and death: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.". The words “succeeded” and “drawing” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 95 shapes its tone: “But Godber’s man wasn’t going to have his story snatched from under his very nose.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “snatched” (paragraph 95) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to life and death: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

16. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 131 shapes its tone: “Wherever you looked there were couples strolling, bending to the flowers, greeting, moving on over the lawn.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “strolling” and “greeting” (paragraph 131) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to coming of age: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

17. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 106 to the story's treatment of life and death: “If you’re going to stop a band playing every time some one has an accident, you’ll lead a very strenuous life.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 106) develops life and death: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.". Its words “strenuous” and “accident” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “If some one had died there normally—and I can’t understand how they keep alive in those poky little holes—we should…” (paragraph 117), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating life and death as central.

18. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 155 reveal about the character or situation? “And, Laura!’—her mother followed her out of the marquee—‘don’t on any account———” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 155) shows the situation turning on life and death: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.". The words “followed” and “marquee” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 69 shapes its tone: “The envelope was found at last behind the dining-room clock, though how it had got there Mrs. Sheridan could not imagine.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “envelope” and “imagine” (paragraph 69) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to life and death: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 162 shapes its tone: “To be away from those staring eyes, or to be covered up in anything, one of those women’s shawls even.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “anything” and “staring” (paragraph 162) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to life and death: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
21. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 126 to the story's treatment of life and death: “You ought to have arranged them round the pond with the conductor in the middle on a leaf.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 126) develops life and death: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.". Its words “conductor” and “arranged” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Wherever you looked there were couples strolling, bending to the flowers, greeting, moving on over the lawn.” (paragraph 131), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating life and death as central.
22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 79 to the story's treatment of coming of age: “Cook swept up crusts with the long sandwich knife, and smiled broadly.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 79) develops coming of age: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.". Its words “sandwich” and “broadly” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “I want to see how the men are getting on with the marquee.” (paragraph 88), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating coming of age as central.
23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 103 to the story's treatment of coming of age: “But we can’t possibly have a garden-party with a man dead just outside the front gate.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 103) develops coming of age: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.". Its words “possibly” and “outside” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Little rags and shreds of smoke, so unlike the great silvery plumes that uncurled from the Sheridans’ chimneys.” (paragraph 104), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating coming of age as central.
24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 7 shapes its tone: “It’s so delicious to have an excuse for eating out of doors, and besides, she loved having to arrange things; she always felt she could do it so much better than anybody else.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “delicious” and “arrange” (paragraph 7) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to life and death: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don’t expect sacrifices from us.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
25. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 158 shapes its tone: “She looked up at the pale sky, and all she thought was, ‘Yes, it was the most successful party.’” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “successful” and “thought” (paragraph 158) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than

neutral. That weight points the reader to coming of age: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don't expect sacrifices from us.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 170 to the story's treatment of coming of age: “Her face, puffed up, red, with swollen eyes and swollen lips, looked terrible.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 170) develops coming of age: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don't expect sacrifices from us.". Its words “terrible” and “swollen” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “The gardener had been up since dawn, mowing the lawns and sweeping them, until the grass and the dark flat rosettes…” (paragraph 1), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating coming of age as central.

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 31 shapes its tone: “And there were two tiny spots of sun, one on the inkpot, one on a silver photograph frame, playing too.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “photograph” and “playing” (paragraph 31) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to coming of age: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don't expect sacrifices from us.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 59 shapes its tone: “But at the word ‘Good-bye,’ and although the piano sounded more desperate than ever, her face broke into a brilliant, dreadfully unsympathetic smile.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “unsympathetic” and “dreadfully” (paragraph 59) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to coming of age: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don't expect sacrifices from us.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 30 to the story's treatment of life and death: “Mother says you’re to wear that sweet hat you had on last Sunday.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 30) develops life and death: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don't expect sacrifices from us.". Its words its wording carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “And there were two tiny spots of sun, one on the inkpot, one on a silver photograph frame, playing too.” (paragraph 31), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating life and death as central.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 8 to the story's treatment of coming of age: “She blushed and tried to look severe and even a little bit short-sighted as she came up to them.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 8) develops coming of age: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don't expect sacrifices from us.". Its words “sighted” and “blushed” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “You see, with a thing like a marquee,’ and he turned to Laura in his easy way, ‘you want to put it somewhere where…” (paragraph 14), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating coming of age as central.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Connect this passage from paragraph 20 to the story's treatment of life and death: “And they were so lovely, with their broad, gleaming leaves, and their clusters of yellow fruit.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 20) develops life and death: Mrs. Sheridan says "People like that don't expect sacrifices from us.". Its words “gleaming” and “clusters” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in

"When Laura saw that gesture she forgot all about the karakas in her wonder at him caring for things like that—caring…" (paragraph 21), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating life and death as central.

32. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] In the line "And the perfect afternoon slowly ripened, slowly faded, slowly its petals closed.", what does "ripened" most nearly mean?

    A. to watch over and direct work

    B. grew ripe

    C. in a mysterious, puzzling way

    D. in a way meant to suggest something unspoken

    Key: B (grew ripe)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 12, 15, 16, 17	recall 10, inference 5, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	3, 2, 6, 1, 7, 5, 4, 8, 9, 10, 12, 12, 11, 18, 19, 16, 20, 21	recall 10, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	4, 9, 3, 2, 10, 1, 6, 18, 13, 14, 11, 12, 12, 15, 16, 19, 22, 23	recall 7, inference 6, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	2, 9, 1, 4, 10, 8, 18, 12, 14, 13, 12, 11, 15, 24, 25, 16, 26, 23	recall 6, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	7, 2, 1, 5, 9, 12, 18, 12, 14, 13, 11, 25, 27, 20, 16, 17, 23, 26	recall 5, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	4, 8, 3, 13, 18, 14, 12, 25, 27, 28, 16, 24, 20, 23, 29, 26, 22, 30	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 6, synthesis 5
College Freshman	2, 6, 8, 12, 12, 18, 11, 27, 15, 16, 28, 24, 25, 30, 31, 29, 21, 22	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 6, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	1, 9, 12, 14, 18, 12, 28, 27, 20, 24, 16, 15, 17, 23, 31, 29, 21, 26	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 6, synthesis 6
College Junior	32, 1, 12, 11, 14, 25, 28, 27, 15, 16, 20, 21, 17, 22, 23, 30, 29, 31	recall 2, inference 3, analysis 6, synthesis 7
College Senior	9, 8, 12, 13, 15, 16, 24, 19, 28, 20, 30, 17, 22, 21, 23, 29, 31, 26	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 6, synthesis 8
Graduate / PhD	8, 32, 28, 27, 25, 24, 19, 20, 15, 16, 31, 22, 23, 17, 26, 29, 21, 30	recall 2, inference 0, analysis 8, synthesis 8

Final paper

The Garden Party: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how Katherine Mansfield develops class and privilege across The Garden Party. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in The Garden Party and argue how its meaning changes over the story and why that change matters to life and death.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in The Garden Party. Argue whether the story judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether The Garden Party finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of coming of age. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: Scaffolded support 500-700 words; HS Freshman 700-900 words; HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words; College Freshman 1,500-2,000 words; College Sophomore 2,000-2,500 words; College Junior 2,500-3,000 words; College Senior 3,000-4,000 words; Graduate / PhD 4,000-6,000 words

Evidence requirement: at least 4 quotations from at least two parts of the story. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the paragraph (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.	Specific, arguable and precise; it organizes every section.	Clear and arguable, but broad in places.	States a topic or a summary more than an argument.	Missing, or restates the prompt.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.	Accurate, well-chosen quotations from across the work, all cited; meets the requirement.	Accurate and cited, but clustered in one part of the work.	Too few quotations, or some inaccurate or uncited.	Little or no quoted evidence.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.	Explains how specific words, structure and devices create meaning; weighs a competing reading.	Explains the evidence, with some close reading.	Mostly summary; the link to the claim is asserted, not shown.	Summary only.
Organization	15					

		Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.	Each paragraph advances the argument; transitions show logic.	Logical order with minor jumps.	Order is loose; paragraphs repeat or drift.	No discernible structure.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.	Formal, precise, present tense; MLA format; virtually error-free.	Formal with a few errors that do not obscure meaning.	Informal or error-prone in ways that distract.	Errors obscure meaning.

Exemplar paragraph: Laura's encounter with death shakes, but does not fully break, her class view. The text makes this visible when it says “You are being very absurd, Laura” (The Garden Party, paragraph 123). Her mother says "You are being very absurd, Laura," yet at the cottage Laura says "Forgive my hat," aware of her privilege; she finds the dead man "wonderful, beautiful" and cannot express what she has learned. A full paper would carry this reading through the beginning, middle and end, and answer the strongest competing reading.

Essay assignments

Essay: Class and privilege

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Garden Party teaches about class and privilege. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Katherine Mansfield develops class and privilege in The Garden Party. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Katherine Mansfield develops class and privilege across The Garden Party. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Garden Party (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of class and privilege. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of class and privilege in The Garden Party. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Katherine Mansfield's choices in The Garden Party (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of class and privilege, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Garden Party's treatment of class and privilege in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on class and privilege in The Garden Party that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on class and privilege in The Garden Party. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about class and privilege in The Garden Party, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on class and privilege in The Garden Party, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Life and death

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Garden Party teaches about life and death. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Katherine Mansfield develops life and death in The Garden Party. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Katherine Mansfield develops life and death across The Garden Party. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Garden Party (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of life and death. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of life and death in The Garden Party. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Katherine Mansfield's choices in The Garden Party (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of life and death, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Garden Party's treatment of life and death in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on life and death in The Garden Party that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on life and death in The Garden Party. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about life and death in The Garden Party, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on life and death in The Garden Party, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Coming of age

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Garden Party teaches about coming of age. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Katherine Mansfield develops coming of age in The Garden Party. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Katherine Mansfield develops coming of age across The Garden Party. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Garden Party (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of coming of age. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of coming of age in The Garden Party. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Katherine Mansfield's choices in The Garden Party (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of coming of age, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Garden Party's treatment of coming of age in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on coming of age in The Garden Party that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on coming of age in The Garden Party. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

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